

■ Exit Points

■ What is it?

Exit points let users pause or leave a flow.

They give people clear ways to back out without feeling stuck or forced.

For example, when signing up for a service, a “**Save and Finish Later**” button acts as an exit point.

■■ History

The idea of building “graceful exits” into systems has long been part of **human factors and usability research**.

From **aircraft controls** to **web forms**, designers learned that people trust systems more when they can stop, pause, or reverse actions without penalty.

In digital UX, this evolved into clear “Back,” “Cancel,” or “Save Later” options.

■ The Psychology Behind It

- People feel **more in control** when exits are visible.
- Without exits, users feel **trapped**, leading to stress, frustration, or abandonment.
- In long or multi-step processes, **knowing they can pause or skip** reduces anxiety.

This boosts user confidence and overall trust in the system.

■■ Why It Matters

Without exit points, users may:

- Feel trapped and stressed
- Rage-click or force quit
- Abandon processes altogether

With exit points, users gain:

- Higher trust
- Reduced drop-offs
- More satisfaction
- A sense of control

■ How to Apply It

- **Add Back or Cancel buttons** → clear escape routes.
- **Offer Save and Continue Later** → reduce abandonment in forms or onboarding.
- **Allow skipping non-essential steps** → keep users moving forward.
- **Show previews or opt-outs** → let users check before committing.
- **Use friendly modals** → confirm actions without sounding forceful.

■ Theory in Action

- **Google Forms** lets people skip optional questions and return later without losing data, reducing pressure.
- **Supermarkets** design wide aisles and visible exits, so shoppers can leave sections without backtracking.

■ Final Thought

Great UX isn't just about guiding users—it's also about giving them a way out.

Exit points show respect for users' time and control. When leaving feels easy and stress-free, people are **more likely to return** and continue the journey later.